

USER_GUIDE

BobaLink — User Guide

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-06-10T21:00:00Z **Scope:** End-user guide for BobaLink, the Boba Project browser extension (extension/). **Authority:** docs/browser_extension/Status.md (Rev 4) + docs/browser_extension/IMPLEMENTATION_PLAN.md.

Accuracy note (§11.4.6): every statement below reflects the real extension source/config as of HEAD 2011810. Capabilities still in progress are marked **(planned)** or **(in progress)** so nothing reads as shipped that is not.

What BobaLink does

BobaLink is a cross-browser **Manifest V3** WebExtension (built with WXT + TypeScript). It:

- **detects** magnet links and .torrent file URLs on the pages you visit;
- **parses** them (magnet bti_h infohash / .torrent → SHA-1 infohash) and **deduplicates** by infohash so the same torrent is never sent twice;
- **forwards** them to the **Boba merge service on `http://localhost:7187`**, which adds them to qBittorrent server-side.

The extension never talks to qBittorrent directly — it only knows about the Boba merge service on port 7187. (extension/wxt.config.ts host_permissions = http://localhost:7187/*; extension/src/shared/constants.ts DEFAULT_URLS.)

The end-to-end detect → send → torrent-appears-in-qBittorrent path against a **live** backend is **(in progress)** — Phase 4 in the plan. The detection, parsing, dedup, and UI layers are implemented and tested.

Supported torrent sites

Detection works on **any page** via the generic magnet: and .torrent link patterns. In addition, BobaLink ships a curated selector table (SITE_SELECTORS in extension/src/shared/constants.ts) tuned for these hosts. The content script's matches are derived from this table — BobaLink does **not** request <all_urls>.

The curated table covers **24 entries** (one generic pattern set plus 23 site-specific hosts):

#	Host	Notes
—	generic	magnet / .torrent / download.php?id= patterns applied everywhere
1	1337x.to	
2	thepiratebay.org	
3	thepiratebay10.org	
4	rarbg.to	
5	rarbgtorrents.org	
6	yts.mx	
7	yts.lt	
8	eztv.re	
9	limetorrents.lol	
10	torrentgalaxy.to	
11	nyaa.si	anime
12	animetosho.org	
13	torrentz2.eu	
14	fitgirl-repacks.site	
15	rutracker.org	Boba private tracker
16	kinozal.tv	Boba private tracker
17	nnmclub.to	Boba private tracker
18	rutor.info	Boba public tracker
19	katcr.co	Kickass Torrents
20	demonoid.is	
21	iptorrents.com	Boba private tracker
22	torrentleech.org	private
23	beyond-hd.me	private
24	passthepopcorn.me	private

(That is 23 site-specific hosts plus the generic set — the project refers to this as the **24 supported sites** table.)

How detection works

- The content script scans the page for magnet links and .torrent URLs using the site selectors above plus the generic regex patterns (MAGNET_REGEX, TORRENT_FILE_REGEX in constants.ts).
 - It watches the page for changes with a MutationObserver (500 ms debounce — DEBOUNCE_DELAYS.MUTATION) so links added by single-page-app navigation are picked up too.
 - Each detected item is parsed to its infohash and **deduplicated by lowercase infohash**, so the same torrent appearing in several places on a page is sent once.
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The popup

Click the BobaLink toolbar icon to open the popup. It shows the torrents detected on the current page and lets you send them to Boba:

- **Send** — send a single selected detected item to the Boba merge service.
- **Send All** — send every detected item on the current page (deduplicated).

The popup also surfaces a connection/status indicator (badge colours are defined in BADGE_COLORS: healthy / degraded / error / scanning / detected).

The live-backend round-trip these buttons perform is **(in progress)** — Phase 4. The popup, detected-list rendering, and Send / Send-All wiring are implemented and tested.

Context-menu actions

Right-click a page (or a magnet link) to use BobaLink's context-menu items (defined in extension/src/background/index.ts):

- **Send magnet to Boba** (bobalink-send) — send the right-clicked magnet link.
- **Send all on page** (bobalink-send-all) — send every detected torrent on the current page.
- **Send tab group** (bobalink-send-group) — scan **every tab in the current tab group**, deduplicate across the whole group, and send them as one batch.

The “Send tab group” batch path is wired (MENU_SEND_GROUP → deduped group batch → a single addMagnets request). It is a Chrome-family feature (uses `chrome.tabGroups`); on browsers without tab groups it degrades gracefully.

You can hide the context-menu items from **Options → UI → Show context-menu items**.

Keyboard shortcuts

Three shortcuts are declared in `extension/wxt.config.ts` (commands):

Action	Windows / Linux	macOS
Send to Boba (send-to-boba)	Ctrl+Shift+B	Command+Shift+B
Scan page (scan-page)	Ctrl+Shift+S	Command+Shift+S
Open dashboard (open- dashboard)	Ctrl+Shift+D	Command+Shift+D

These are *suggested* keys; your browser may let you remap them on its extension shortcuts page (e.g. `chrome://extensions/shortcuts`). You can disable shortcut handling from **Options → UI → Enable keyboard shortcuts**.

The 7 options tabs

Open the options page (right-click the icon → Options, or your browser’s extension-details “Extension options”). It has **seven tabs** (`extension/src/entrypoints/options/index.html` + `src/options/options.ts`, `TAB_IDS`):

1. **Server** — server name, **Server URL** (default `http://localhost:7187`), authentication method (None / Username+Password cookie / API Key / Basic), the optional **Boba API token** + **Session passphrase** (see below), connection timeout (seconds), health-check interval (minutes), and “Verify HTTPS certificates (HTTPS only)”.
2. **Download Prefs** — default category, default save path, content layout (Original / Create subfolder / No subfolder), pause-after-add, skip hash check, automatic torrent management.
3. **Queue** — enable the offline queue for failed sends, max queue size (default 50), max history items (default 100).

4. **Notifications** — show notifications, play a sound on completion, auto-send detected torrents (no confirmation).
 5. **Detection** — automatically scan pages, auto-scan delay (ms), highlight detected torrents, highlight style (Badge / Border / Glow).
 6. **UI** — show context-menu items, enable keyboard shortcuts.
 7. **Security** — explains the delegate-by-default model and offers an “Enable debug logging” toggle.
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The optional Boba API token + session passphrase

BobaLink follows a **delegate-by-default** security model: in the normal localhost deployment it stores **no decryptable secret at all** — it just posts magnets/URLs to the local merge service, which already owns the qBittorrent and tracker credentials.

The **only** optional secret is a **Boba API token**, which is needed *only if* your Boba backend sets the `BOBA_API_TOKEN` environment variable (the backend token gate is open by default and enforced only when that variable is set).

When you supply a token on the **Server** tab, BobaLink encrypts it **only under a session passphrase you type** (AES-GCM-256 via PBKDF2 — `ENCRYPTION` in `constants.ts`):

- The passphrase is held in `chrome.storage.session` only and is **never persisted** to disk.
- There is **no fixed/embedded encryption key and no empty-passphrase path** — if you enter a token but no passphrase, the token is **not stored** and a notice tells you to add a passphrase (`src/options/options.ts`).
- The plaintext token and the passphrase are never logged.

When the token is present and unlocked, the Phase-4 client sends it as either an `Authorization: Bearer <token>` or `X-Boba-Token: <token>` header (`BOBA_TOKEN_HEADERS`). Full decrypt-and-send wiring is landed and tested; the end-to-end against a live token-gated backend is **(in progress)**.

Least-privilege permissions — what BobaLink asks for and why

BobaLink requests only what it needs (`extension/wxt.config.ts`):

Permission	Why it is requested
storage	persist your settings, detected items, the offline queue, and history
alarms	keep the service worker alive and run periodic health checks
notifications	tell you when a send succeeds/fails
activeTab	act on the page you explicitly invoke BobaLink on
contextMenus	provide the right-click “Send ...” actions
tabGroups	read which group the clicked tab belongs to, for “Send tab group”
host_permissions: http://localhost:7187/ *	talk to the local Boba merge service — nothing else

What BobaLink deliberately does not request

- **tabs** — the tab-group batcher reads only `tab.id`, which per the Chrome docs needs no tabs permission. BobaLink never reads tab URLs/titles/favicons.
- **scripting** — not requested.
- **cookies** — not requested; BobaLink never touches your cookies.
- **<all_urls>** — the content script’s match patterns are derived from the curated `SITE_SELECTORS` table, not a blanket all-sites grant.

Its content security policy is tight: `script-src 'self'` (no `unsafe-inline` / `unsafe-eval`), and `connect-src` scoped to `http://localhost:7187` (`content_security_policy` in `wxt.config.ts`).

Internationalization & accessibility

- BobaLink ships UI message catalogs for **English (en)**, **Russian (ru)**, **German (de)**, and **French (fr)** (`src/public/_locales/{en,ru,de,fr}`, packaged into the build). Chrome/Firefox auto-select by the browser UI language, falling back to English. More locales are **(planned)** (the plan targets 8).
- The popup and options UI carry ARIA roles, accessible names, and `tablist/tabpanel` wiring, validated by an accessibility test suite. Deeper WCAG work (contrast/focus/full keyboard coverage) and theme-switch evidence are **(in progress)**.

Current status at a glance

Phases 1-3 (foundation, detection/parsing, the content/background/popup/options shell) plus the WXT build wiring are **PASS**. Backend integration (Phase 4), tab-group batch polish (Phase 5), i18n/a11y/themes (Phase 6), the full security/credentials suite (Phase 7), full multi-type test coverage (Phase 8), and distribution (Phase 9) are **in progress**. See `docs/browser_extension/Status.md` for the authoritative per-phase state.